1. India — direct evidence of sodium-ion development

These are the strongest sources for demonstrating a concrete shift from research towards industrial validation and deployment.

#	Source and direct link	What it documents
1	NTPC — Sodium-ion grid-connected BESS pilot EOI	Public-sector utility initiative to evaluate sodium-ion technology in a grid-connected battery storage pilot. The official NTPC tender listing also displays the tender and its listed deadline.  ntpctender.ntpc.co.in
2	PIB — ARCI–Voltasun sodium-ion cell validation agreement	December 2025 agreement covering 80 sodium-ion pouch cells, industrial-performance evaluation, and potential commercialisation of indigenous sodium vanadium phosphate cathode technology.  Press Information Bureau
3	DST — JNCASR fast-charging sodium-ion battery research	Indian research achievement reporting 80% charging in six minutes and more than 3,000 cycles in the tested design. The release explicitly states that further development is required before market deployment.  Department Of Science & Technology (DST)

4	Technology Development Board — Indigenous Energy Storage Technologies, biomass-derived hard carbon	April 2026 financial assistance for scaling domestic production of hard carbon, a key sodium-ion anode material. Particularly relevant to domestic supply-chain independence.



Technology Development Board

5	Technology Development Board — NOPO Nanotechnologies sodium-ion project	December 2025 industrial R&D support for assessing single-walled carbon nanotubes in sodium-ion batteries and developing a proof-of-concept prototype.



Technology Development Board

Recommended use in MACH1: Sources 2, 4 and 5 demonstrate that Indian public funding is extending beyond fundamental research into cell validation, advanced materials and commercialisation-oriented development. Source 1 demonstrates a concrete public-sector deployment evaluation.

2. India — government policy, import dependence and storage demand

These sources support the broader strategic rationale. Be precise: they demonstrate policies favouring domestic battery manufacturing, critical-mineral security and storage expansion, rather than a universal government mandate to replace lithium-ion with sodium-ion.

#	Source and direct link	What it documents
6	Ministry of Heavy Industries — parliamentary reply on dependence on imported lithium-ion batteries	Official Lok Sabha reply of 12 August 2025 acknowledging India's dependence on Asian supply chains, associated price and supply risks, and the implementation status of the ACC manufacturing scheme.



		Heavy Industries Ministry
7	Ministry of Heavy Industries — PLI scheme for Advanced Chemistry Cell battery storage	The ₹18,100 crore manufacturing programme, including its gigascale manufacturing and domestic-value-addition objectives. This is broad battery-industry policy, not a dedicated sodium-ion subsidy.
		 Ministry of Heavy Industries
8	PIB — National Critical Mineral Mission	Official announcement of the ₹16,300 crore mission and its objectives for domestic mineral exploration, processing, recovery and supply-chain security.
		 Press Information Bureau
9	PIB — India's projected energy-storage requirement	Government-reported Central Electricity Authority estimates of 336 GWh by 2029–30 and 411 GWh by 2031–32. These are storage requirements, not sodium-ion targets.
		 Press Information Bureau
10	Ministry of Power — parliamentary response on energy storage	The underlying parliamentary document supporting the 336 GWh and 411 GWh storage estimates and the role of storage in renewable integration.
		 18.12.2025.docx

3. India — the NETRA import-reduction forecast

Source	What it supports
ETEnergyworld / PTI — non-lithium batteries and India's storage-import dependence	The 15 October 2026 report describes a NETRA survey suggesting that non-lithium technologies—including sodium-ion, vanadium flow and zinc-based batteries—could reduce India's storage-import dependence by 2035.



ETEnergyworld.com

Important qualification: This is an industry-survey forecast reported by PTI, not a government notification. The article states that the survey report was due to be formally unveiled on 24 October 2026. Cite it as evidence of industry expectations, not as an adopted national target.

4. International technical and economic evidence

These sources help establish why governments and manufacturers are considering sodium-ion in the first place.

#	Source and direct link	What it documents
11	International Energy Agency — Global Critical Minerals Outlook 2025: emerging battery supply chains	Sodium-ion's upstream supply-chain diversification potential, alongside continued Chinese dominance in cells, cathodes and hard-carbon anodes.
12	International Energy Agency — Global EV Outlook 2026: electric-vehicle batteries	Sodium-ion scale-up, low-temperature performance, energy-density limitations, manufacturing-capacity comparisons and exposure to lithium-price spikes. This is one of the most useful overall sources for a 2035 technology argument.



IEA



		IEA
13	Heliyon — Na ion batteries: An India centric review (2022)	Open-access review of sodium-ion research, economics, materials, Indian industrial development and potential government strategies. Useful for technical context alongside newer policy records.
		 ScienceDirect

5. International government funding and deployment

These show that sodium-ion is being developed beyond India.

#	Source and direct link	What it documents
14	US Department of Energy — FY2024 Vehicle Technologies Office R&D funding selections	The DOE announced $51.7 million across 19 selected projects, including $6.42 million for five sodium-ion battery projects. The announcement also clarifies that project selection is not itself a guarantee of a final award.
		 Department of Energy
15	European Commission — CORDIS: NASCALE project	An EU-backed project to scale up sodium-ion cathode-active-material production and strengthen a European value chain. The CORDIS record lists an EU contribution of approximately €2.5 million.
		 European Commission

16	China National Energy Administration — aqueous sodium-ion demonstration project	A grid-storage demonstration using aqueous sodium-ion technology. The release reports a 66 kWh system connected for trial operation at a 220 kV substation on 19 March 2025.



National Energy Administration

6. China — sodium-ion-specific national standards

These are useful evidence of an emerging industrial ecosystem, rather than evidence of Indian policy.

Standard	Official source	Relevance
GB/T 44265-2024	China National Standards database — technical specifications for sodium-ion batteries in electrical-energy-storage power stations	Published 23 August 2024; effective 1 March 2025.  openstd.samr.gov.cn
GB/T 48072-2026	China National Standards database — safety specification for sodium-ion cells and batteries in energy-storage systems	Published 28 August 2026; scheduled to take effect 1 March 2027.  openstd.samr.gov.cn

7. Union Budget 2026–27 — an important correction

The previous response used these sources to distinguish actual sodium-ion policy from a misleading interpretation of customs-duty exemptions.

Source	What the official record says
Union Budget 2026–27 speech (PDF)	The budget speech proposes exempting sodium antimonate used in solar-glass manufacturing from basic customs duty. It separately refers to capital goods for manufacturing lithium-ion cells for battery energy-storage systems.  India Budget
Customs Notification No. 02/2026 (PDF)	The legal customs notification specifies the sodium-antimonate exemption for solar glass, rather than sodium-ion batteries.  02_2026_Customs_eng

Do not cite the sodium-antimonate exemption as direct evidence of a sodium-ion battery-manufacturing incentive.

Which sources deserve the most weight in your report?

For a convincing and defensible argument, I would build the central evidence chain around these five:

1. Ministry of Heavy Industries — import dependence for the Indian supply-chain problem.
2. IEA — Global Critical Minerals Outlook 2025 for the geopolitical and material-diversification rationale.
3. PIB — ARCI–Voltasun cell-validation agreement for indigenous R&D moving towards industrial validation.
4. TDB — domestic hard-carbon commercialisation for development of a critical domestic sodium-ion input.
5. NTPC — sodium-ion grid-storage pilot for a documented public-sector deployment evaluation.

Together, these establish the most defensible conclusion: India is actively developing the broader domestic battery ecosystem while taking concrete steps to evaluate sodium-ion technology. That supports a sodium-ion-first design thesis for a vehicle targeting 2035, without requiring the stronger—and currently unsupported—claim that the government has decided to replace lithium-ion.